To import a database from your on-premises environment to Amazon RDS, follow these steps:

1. Export the database.
2. Start a virtual machine in the same region and VPC as the RDS database.
3. Upload the database dump to the virtual machine.
4. Run an import of the database dump to the RDS database on the virtual server.

We'll skip the first step of exporting a MySQL database, because the RDS instance we created in our example is empty and you may not have access to an existing WordPress database. The next sidebar gives you hints on how to create a database dump in case you need that for your real-world systems later.

Exporting a MySQL database

MySQL (and every other database system) offers a way to export and import databases. We recommend using the command-line tools from MySQL for exporting and importing databases. You may need to install the MySQL client, which comes with the `mysqldump` tool.

The following command exports all databases from localhost and dumps them into a file called dump.sql. Replace `$UserName` with the MySQL admin user, and enter the password when prompted:

```
$ mysqldump -u $UserName -p --all-databases > dump.sql
```

You can also specify only some databases for the export, as shown next. To do so, replace `$DatabaseName` with the name of the database you want to export: